

Google group (<https://groups.google.com/forum/#!topic/scala-functional/>) and the #fp-in-scala IRC channel on [irc.freenode.net](https://freenode.net) for questions and discussion.

Exercises are marked for both their difficulty and importance. We will mark exercises that we think are *hard* or that we consider to be *optional* to understanding the material. The *hard* designation is our effort to give you some idea of what to expect—it is only our guess and you may find some unmarked questions difficult and some questions marked *hard* to be quite easy. The *optional* designation is for exercises that are informative but can be skipped without impeding your ability to follow further material. The exercises have the following icons in front of them to denote whether or not they are optional:



EXERCISE 1

A filled-in square next to an exercise means the exercise is critical.



EXERCISE 2

An open square means the exercise is optional.

Examples are presented throughout the book, and they are meant to be *tried* rather than just read. Before you begin, you should have the Scala interpreter running and ready. We encourage you to experiment on your own with variations of what you see in the examples. A good way to understand something is to change it slightly and see how the change affects the outcome.

Sometimes we will show a Scala interpreter session to demonstrate the result of running or evaluating some code. This will be marked by lines beginning with the `scala>` prompt of the interpreter. Code that follows this prompt is to be typed or pasted into the interpreter, and the line just below will show the interpreter's response, like this:

```
scala> println("Hello, World!")  
Hello, World!
```

Code conventions and downloads

All source code in listings or in text is in a fixed-width font like this to separate it from ordinary text. Key words in Scala are set in **bold fixed-width font like this**. Code annotations accompany many of the listings, highlighting important concepts.

To download the source code for the examples in the book, the exercise code, and the chapter notes, please go to <https://github.com/fpinscala/fpinscala> or to the publisher's website at www.manning.com/FunctionalProgramminginScala.